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Lead Delivery Manager

Government Digital Service

Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 10th May 2026

Government Digital Service

Reference number

459789

Salary

£67,972 - £83,027

£73,280 - £83,027 (London) / £67,972 - £75,275 (National) Based on capability. The base salary of this grade is £71,370 for London and £67,126 for other locations. Offers made above this will be made up with a specialist pay allowance.

Job grade

Grade 6

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

GDS - Digital Identity & One Login

Type of role

Digital
Information Technology

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time, Compressed hours

Number of jobs available

4

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Location

Bristol, London, Manchester

About the job

Job summary

The Government Digital Service (GDS) is the digital centre of government. We are responsible for setting, leading and delivering the vision for a modern digital government.

Our priorities are to drive a modern digital government, by:

1. joining up public sector services
2. harnessing the power of AI for the public good
3. strengthening and extending our digital and data public infrastructure
4. elevating leadership and investing in talent
5. funding for outcomes and procuring for growth and innovation
6. committing to transparency and driving accountability

We are home to the Incubator for Artificial Intelligence (I.AI), the world-leading GOV.UK and are at the forefront of coordinating the UK s geospatial strategy and activity. We lead the Government Digital and Data function and champion the work of digital teams across government.

We re part of the Department for Science, Innovation and Technology (DSIT) and employ more than 1,000 people all over the UK, with hubs in Manchester, London and Bristol.

The Government Digital Service is where talent translates into impact. From your first day, you ll be working with some of the world s most highly-skilled digital professionals, all contributing their knowledge to make change on a national scale.

Join us for rewarding work that makes a difference across the UK. You'll solve some of the nation s highest-priority digital challenges, helping millions of people access services they need

Job description

The GOV.UK One Login programme is full of talented and passionate people who are consistently delivering high quality products for services and individuals. The right person will join a well motivated and dynamic multi-disciplined delivery organisation working to deliver on our commitments and roadmap.

If you ve got a background in technology delivery and are used to working in a scaled agile environment then this could be the place for you!

Sometimes described as the most strategic programme in government, GOV.UK One Login represents a once in a career opportunity to work on a software product that will be used by the majority of the people living in the UK. It s a fast paced, dynamic and challenging environment that is sure to offer you career satisfaction as well as a chance to develop and enhance your skills.

As a Lead Delivery Manager you will:

- lead and motivate multiple multi-disciplinary teams, helping them organise and plan their work, ensuring they deliver products and services that meet users needs and key timeframes
- shape the programme of work by establishing how the team will work as a team of teams, encompassing internal staff and third party managed services
- identify the people, skills and resources that teams need to deliver to the agreed goals
- ensure teams understand their mission, vision and goals, and that these align across the organisation
- use your delivery expertise to actively manage risks, issues and internal & external dependencies across multiple delivery teams. You will act as an escalation point for risks raised by your delivery teams, supporting or intervening as necessary to enable prompt and effective management
- have accountability for your teams delivery plans, and for your area s overall delivery plan; ensuring they have robust processes in place for refining and estimating work and that there is collective confidence in their ability to achieve their commitments

- ensure teams clearly communicate their plans and progress through them using recognised agile practices
- provide clear, timely and accurate reporting to the Head of Delivery and other key stakeholders to support a comprehensive view of the overall programme status form a strong partnership with your Lead Product Manager and Lead Developer counterparts to provide leadership & direction to your team and to effectively engage with and influence relevant senior stakeholders
- ensure the programme strikes the right balance of leveraging Managed Services to augment work, while ensuring long term knowledge retention
- assess effectiveness across multiple delivery teams, engaging with and motivating teams in different ways depending on their needs. Facilitate collaboration across delivery teams as required to ensure objectives are met
- actively participate in the Delivery Manager community, line managing, coaching, mentoring, learning, sharing and applying skills and knowledge to improve delivery capability

Person specification

Our delivery professionals work on a range of products and services within the GDS One Login programme, and work with a range of other stakeholders inside and outside the programme. You ll have strong interpersonal skills and enjoy working in a demanding, high profile environment. You ll be used to accountability, working proactively to make delivery happen, and to working with a degree of uncertainty. You ll be passionate about agile working, care about technology and know how to make projects succeed.

We re interested in people who have:

- a significant track record of successfully delivering difficult and/or complex digital programmes of work, leading, coordinating and motivating multi-site / multi-disciplinary teams through all stages of the delivery lifecycle
- a deep understanding of agile and lean methodologies and experience in applying these practices at scale across an organisation

- led and directed stakeholder engagement and expectation management, moderating difficult discussions about high risk and complex topics, even within constrained timescales
- demonstrated expertise in optimising the delivery flow of teams; actively addressing the most complicated risks, issues and dependencies, driving them to resolution
- led continual planning processes in highly complex digital environments, balancing multiple priorities, dependencies and teams working across complex products whilst delivering value
- experience of identifying and challenging processes that are unnecessarily complicated, adding value by coaching the organisation to inspect & adapt processes and guiding teams through the implementation of new processes
- experience of recruiting, coaching and line management of delivery managers, identifying learning and development opportunities for individuals and team

Benefits

There are many benefits of working at GDS, including:

- flexible hybrid working with flexi-time and the option to work part-time or condensed hours
- a Civil Service Pension with an average employer contribution of 28.97%
- 25 days of annual leave, increasing by a day each year up to a maximum of 30 days
- an extra day off for the King s birthday
- an in-year bonus scheme to recognise high performance
- career progression and coaching, including a training budget for personal development
- a focus on wellbeing with access to an employee assistance programme
- job satisfaction from making government services easier to use and more inclusive for people across the UK
- advances on pay, including for travel season tickets

- death in service benefits
- cycle to work scheme and facilities
- access to an employee discounts scheme
- 10 learning days per year
- volunteering opportunities (5 special leave days per year)
- access to a suite of learning activities through Civil Service learning

Any move to Government Digital Service from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may however be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax Free Childcare. Determine your eligibility at https://www.childcarechoices.gov.uk

Office attendance
The Department operates a discretionary hybrid working policy, which provides for a combination of working hours from your place of work and from your home in the UK. The current expectation for staff is to attend the office or non-home based location for 40-60% of the time over the accounting period.
DSIT does not normally offer full home working (i.e. working at home); but we do offer a variety of flexible working options (including occasionally working from home).

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance (opens in a new window) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

The standard selection process for roles at GDS consists of:

- a simple application screening process - We only ask for a CV and cover letter of up to 750 words. Important tip - please ensure that your cover letter includes how you meet the skills and experience listed in the person specification section above
- a 20 minute phone screen (conducted over Google Meet)
- a 75 minute video interview. As part of the interview process there will be a presentation task. Details of the presentation task will be provided to shortlisted candidates.

Depending on how many applications we get, there might also be an extra stage before the video interview, for example a phone interview or a technical exercise.

In the event we receive a high volume of applications, we will conduct the initial sift against the lead criteria which is:

- a significant track record of successfully delivering difficult and/or complex digital programmes of work, leading, coordinating and motivating multi-site / multi-disciplinary teams through all stages of the delivery lifecycle

In the Civil Service, we use Success Profiles to evaluate your skills and ability. This gives us the best possible chance of finding the right person for the job, increases performance and improves diversity and inclusivity. We ll be assessing your technical abilities, skills, experience and behaviours that are relevant to this role.

For this role we ll be assessing you against the following Civil Service Behaviours:

- changing and improving
- making effective decisions
- leadership
- delivering at pace
- working together

We ll also be assessing your experience and specialist technical skills against the following skills defined in the Government Digital and Data Capability Framework for the Head of (agile) Delivery Management role:

- Agile and Lean practices
- Communicating between the technical and non-technical
- Life cycle management
- Maintaining delivery momentum
- Making a process work
- Planning
- Team dynamics and collaboration

Want to know more about who Government Digital and Data are? Click Here

Recruitment Timeline

Sift completion: Friday 22nd May 2026

Phone screens: starting Monday 1st June 2026

Panel interviews: starting Monday 15 June 2026

Candidates that do not pass the interview but have demonstrated an acceptable standard may be considered for similar roles at a lower grade.

A reserve list will be held for a period of 12 months, from which further appointments can be made.

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan and the Civil Service D&I Strategy.

Please note that this role requires SC clearance, which would normally need 5 years UK residency in the past 5 years. This is not an absolute requirement, but supplementary checks may be needed where individuals have not lived in the UK for that period. This may mean your security clearance (and therefore your appointment) will take longer or, in some cases, not be possible.

For meaningful checks to be carried out, you will need to have lived in the UK for a sufficient period of time, to enable appropriate checks to be carried out and produce a result which provides the required level of assurance. Whilst a lack of UK residency in itself is not necessarily a bar to a security clearance, and expectation of UK residency may range from 3 to 5 years. Failure to meet the residency requirements needed for the role may result in the withdrawal of provisional jobs offers.

Sponsorship

DSIT cannot offer Visa sponsorship to candidates through this campaign. DSIT holds a Visa sponsorship licence but this can only be used for certain roles and this campaign does not qualify.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is security check (opens in a new window).

See our vetting charter (opens in a new window).

People working with government assets must complete baseline personnel security standard (opens in new window) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals
- nationals of the Republic of Ireland
- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status

under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS) (opens in a new window)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

Further information on nationality requirements (opens in a new window)

Working for the Civil Service

The Civil Service Code (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's recruitment principles (opens in a new window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan (opens in a new window) and the Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy (opens in a new window).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the Great Place to Work for Veterans (opens in a new window) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. Read more about prison leaver recruitment (opens in new window).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Email : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Further information

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, you should contact gds-complaints@dsit.gov.uk in the first instance.

If you are not satisfied with the response you receive you can contact the Civil Service Commission by email: info@csc.gov.uk Or in writing: Civil Service Commission, Room G/8 1 Horse Guards Road, London, SW1A 2HQ.

Civil Service Commission

disability confident EMPLOYER